

FAST

ISLAMIC & RELIGIOUS STUDIES

LECTURE NO 1

Intro to Quran & Tafseer





INTRODUCTION TO THE HOLY QUR'AN

◦The Name of the Qur`an & Reason For it

- Allama Abul Maali listed 55 names of the Qur`an
- Some Scholars have continued them to be more than 90
- The fact is that they have reached these numbers by considering the attributes of the Qur`an .

The Names of the Qur`an

1. AL Qur`an

THE READING

2. AL FURQAN

THE CRITERATION

3. AZ ZIKR

THE ADVICE

4. AL KITAB

THE BOOK

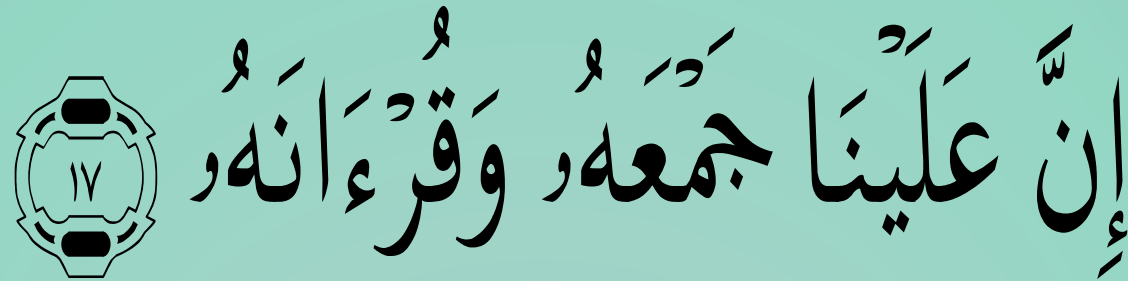
5. AL TANZEEL

THE REVELATION

- The Holy Qur`an itself has used these five words as its proper names.
- The most popular is Al Qur`an
- Allah himself has called it with this name in almost 61 places.

Meaning of Qur`an

- The Word Qur`an is derived from **قرأ يقرأ** which literally means “to collect”
- Later, this word came to be used for “reading” because the words and letters are collected together while reading something.



“surely upon us rests the collecting thereof, and the reciting thereof”

Why the name is Qur`an

- To refute the unbelievers of Arabia as they used to say

وَقَالَ الَّذِينَ كَفَرُوا لَا تَسْمَعُوا هَذَا الْقُرْآنَ وَالْغَوْا فِيهِ لَعَلَّكُمْ تَغْلِبُونَ ﴿٢٦﴾

- “Don’t listen to this Qur`an , but boo loudly during its recital (Al Qur`an 41:26)
- The message of Qur`an cannot be suppressed by such means.
- The book is revealed to be read and it shall be read till the last day.
- **Its now an established fact that the holy Qur`an is the most widely read book in the world**

Conventional Definition of Qur`an

المنزل علي الرسول, المكتوب في المصاحف , المنقول اليها نقلا متواترا بلا شبهة “
”

The words of Allah that were revealed to his Messenger ﷺ , written in books and narrated continuously from him without any doubt”

This Definition is unanimously accepted by all the learned scholars.



FACTS ABOUT WAHI DIVINE REVELATION

Why is the man sent to this world?

- He must make use of the universe around him in the right manner
- He must do it according to Allah's Will
- For both, he needs "Knowledge"

Sources of Knowledge



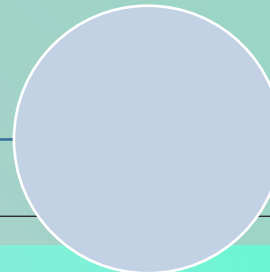
JURISDICTION OF THESE SOURCES



A man
in the
dessert



He has a
Father ?



Why is
he
created ?

The Jurisdiction of these sources

- All these sources have their defined jurisdiction.
- We can see through eyes the things that can be seen, but can't think through them
- Since there is a limitation, each source has its own limit and provides its use in this radius of limitation.
- The intellect, too helps man to a certain limit, then leaves him helpless in many cases.

Divine Revelation

The Third Source of Knowledge

Almighty Allah has granted us another source of knowledge to help and guide us where the jurisdiction of other two sources fails.

“WAHY”

Essentially, Knowledge from human effort is also from allah

Ta`wil: Literal Meaning

- To return
- To attribute
- Technically
 - “Explanation based on personal reasoning”



DIFFERENCE BETWEEN TAFSIR & TAWIL

TAFSIR

- Explanation based on Narration (Riwayah)
- Quoted from traditions or reports of prophet, companions

TAWIL

- Explanation based on Correct opinion and understanding (Dirayah)



Classification of Tafsir

1. Tafsir bi al Mathur
2. Tafsir bi al Ra`i (Opinions)



Tafsir bi al Mathur

- Qur`an by Qur`an
- Qur`an by Hadith
- Qur`an by Companion's Sayings
- Qur`an by their followers Sayings



Tafsir bi al Ra`i

- A. Ra`i al-Mahmud: Opinion conforms to the Qur`an, Sunnah, Objectives of Shariah, Arabic Language and its style

- B. Ra`I al-Madhmum: Against Mahmud, based on mere intellect



Authentic Sources of Exegesis

***Qur'an
itself***

***Prophetic
Traditions***

***Sayings of
the
Companions***

***Sayings of
the
followers
of them***

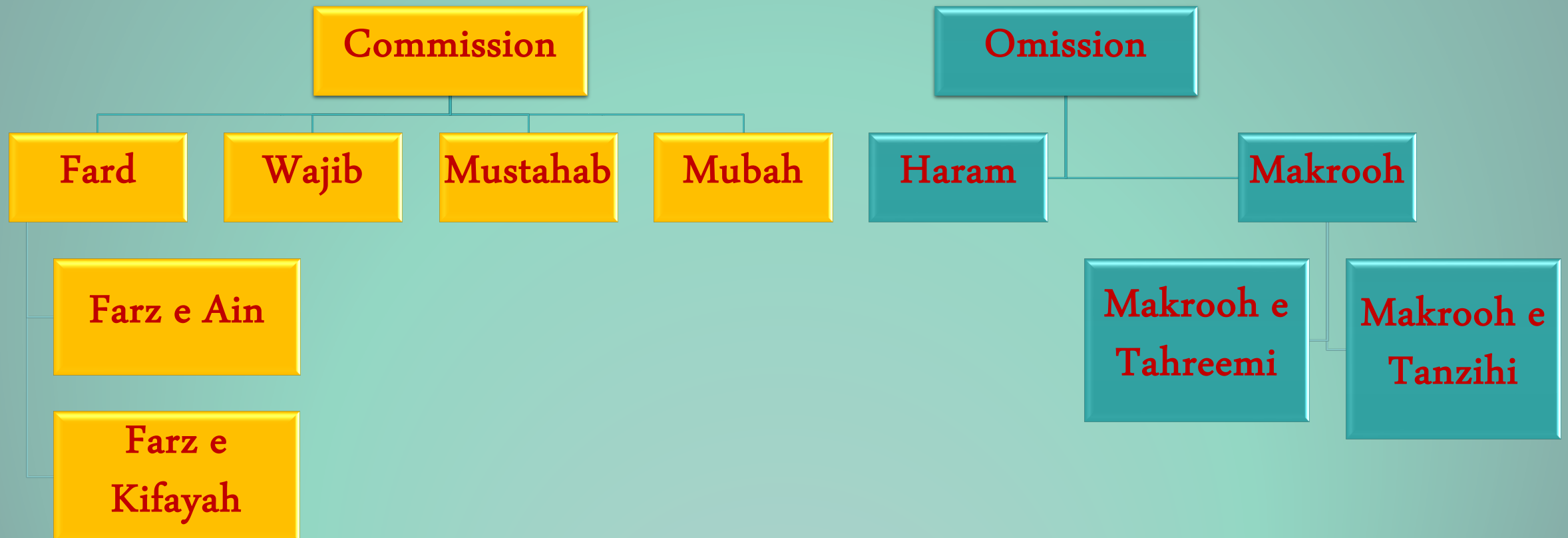
***Arabic
Lexicon***

***Common
Sense***

Five Sciences of Quran

- Science of Injunctions (Ahkam)
- Science of Debates/Arguments (Mukhasama)
- Science of Divine Favours
- Science of the Important events of Allah
- Science of death and life after death

Sciences of Ahkaam



Five Sciences of Quran

- Quran uses the style of classic arabs and explains matters in a short concise manner.
- Has not gone in details like the Fuqaha (Jurists) and specific events/incidents (Juzyiaat)
- Addresses debates/arguments in general accepted principles and not in the style of logicians and philosophers



Science of Debates/Arguments (Mukhasama)

Four Misguided Sects

➤ Jews

➤ Christians

➤ Idol worshippers

➤ Hypocrites

Science of Divine Favours

- Bounties on a person on earth
- Heaven
- Creation of Heaven and Earth
- Guidance which people received to live with prosperity in this life and the hereafter

Science of the Important events of Allah

- Stories of the Prophets
- Punishments of the disobedient
- Favours on the obedient

Science of life after death

- Resurrection
- Gathering
- Accountability and the Balance (Meezan)
- Paradise
- Hell



The
Quran
is for
ourselves,

not our
Shelves



*Dr. Bilal
Phillips*

www.bilalphilips.com



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